



mosaic
multicultural connections



mosaic
multicultural connections

ANNUAL REPORT 2023-2024



OF COUNTRY

ACKNOWLEDGEMENT

Mosaic Multicultural Connections (Mosaic) acknowledges First Nations peoples, the traditional custodians and owners of the Lands on which we work and meet. We pay our respects to elders past, present and emerging.

We acknowledge the spiritual, physical, emotional, mental and economic connections of Aboriginal and Torres Strait Islander people to the Land and Seas.

We acknowledge that the dispossession of Country and the disruption to family relationships have resulted in a breakdown of social networks. We acknowledge that sovereignty of the Land was never ceded. This was, is and always will be land of First Nations peoples

ACKNOWLEDGEMENT

Mosaic Multicultural Connections (Mosaic) acknowledges that the people of New South Wales are of different linguistic, religious and ancestral backgrounds who are free to profess, practice and maintain their own linguistic, religious and ancestral heritage.

We are committed to compliment and empower multicultural people and communities to contribute and belong in order to live their best life.

We recognise the linguistic and cultural assets of multicultural communities as a valuable resource and promote this resource to maximise the development of Mosaic and our wider Australian community.

We acknowledge our responsibility to ensure that services are culturally competent, culturally safe and sensitive.

OF CULTURES





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On behalf of the Board, I would like to thank each and every Mosaic staff member and volunteer. It is because of your trust, collaboration, compassion and dedication, that Mosaic has continued delivering our work in supporting our culturally diverse people and communities.

It has been yet another challenging year for the NFP community sector in general. As I noted last year, the demand for increased accountability across all areas of governance continues.

The executive leadership team and the Board have continued to work hard to ensure that Mosaic, as an organization, is fit for our mission as legislative and governance standards constantly change. This is particularly relevant in aged care with the introduction of a new Aged Care Act expected to commence from 1 July 2025.

Mosaic was audited by the Aged Care Quality and Safety Commission in January 2024, and we were compliant with 38 out of 42 standards. The ACQSC audit was invaluable in identifying opportunities to improve and achieve excellence in supporting our staff and clients.

It was gratifying for the audit to confirm that our consumers and their families felt respected and valued by Mosaic and that we were providing culturally safe care. Significantly, an ACQSC review audit in September 2024 has confirmed the outstanding progress made by the entire Aged Care Team in addressing non-compliant areas and Mosaic is now fully compliant.

Mosaic successfully applied for and has been awarded the Settlement Engagement and Transition Support (SETS) contract for the next 3 years, a recognition of the valuable work done by our Settlement and Families Team.

This team continues to welcome refugee migrant communities across all our areas (from the Central Coast, Hunter to Tamworth and the New England) and provide invaluable assistance during their settlement journey.

The REAP program in the New England is evolving as the Ezidis settle into Armidale and increasingly seek educational qualifications (from vocational to tertiary) for current and future employment.

As our organisation has evolved over time, Mosaic has outgrown its office spaces in both Tamworth and Hamilton. Particularly for the Chaucer Street premises, it is time for a bittersweet farewell as we move to Charlestown to a building that better supports our staff in a contemporary community focused service.

This decision required significant input from the Board and executive team. I would like to take the opportunity to thank every Board member and the executive for their support, dedication, and valued contribution over the past 12 months and look forward to the future of Mosaic.

Sandra Feltham

Board Chair





As I reflect on the past year, I am deeply conscious of the changes affecting the not-for-profit and community sector. Once upon a time, heart, passion and goodwill were sufficient to drive success. Whilst these qualities will always be crucial, organisations must now strike a delicate balance between maintaining our human-centred approach and adopting modern business practices.

In this climate, Mosaic has undergone a journey of transformation to remain relevant. We have strategically adjusted our staffing structure and invested in roles to support training, quality, data and digital communication. This has enabled us to improve efficiency and enhance our ability to deliver high-quality, impactful programs.

Mosaic's board of voluntary directors have shown unwavering support during this period of unprecedented change. Likewise, our dedicated team of staff has worked tirelessly to remain true to our mission of fostering a connected community where diversity defines and nourishes us. Our team speak over 40 languages, mirroring the diversity of the individuals and communities who we support.

Mosaic has a long history of providing culturally responsive aged care services. This year we turned our attention to the quality of our clinical care, resulting in enhanced care outcomes and recent full compliance with aged care quality standards.

Additionally, our new aged care advisory body gives clients the opportunity to identify areas for improvement so we can better meet the needs of our diverse client base. Our care support workforce is now better trained and resourced, and we continue to recruit for diversity to match the cultural and linguistic preferences of our clients.

In Newcastle and surrounds we commenced delivery of a new program to raise awareness of gambling harm and in Armidale, our BEAM project raised community awareness of how to recognise and support victim-survivors of domestic and family violence. Through our Regional Employment and Agriculture Program (REAP) in Armidale, we continued to support members of the Ezidi community and others to achieve their employment goals. REAP's community co-design model enables us to adapt the program to respond to evolving community aspirations.

We offer our thanks and gratitude to the Rotary Club of Armidale as key partners, especially farmers who have made their land available for participants to farm.

Our team collaborated with other agencies to establish a Multicultural Youth Advisory Committee and deliver a Youth Forum in Armidale, and our Northern Multicultural Youth Exchange connected youth from diverse backgrounds to build relationships and mutual understanding.



Leading with Vision, Inspiring Success

In our core settlement program, we expanded our reach to include Pacific communities, ensuring our services are accessible to a diverse range of newcomers.

As we move into 24-25, our settlement team have embarked on a new era. For the past decade, Mosaic was a proud member of the NSW Settlement Partnership working alongside other leading organisations to provide essential support to people of refugee and migrant background. The consortium disbanded on 30 June 2024 due to changes in funding and Mosaic has secured independent funding to continue delivering this vital support. We now aim to build on our strong partnerships with former consortium members and explore new opportunities to collaborate for increased impact.

Mosaic also relies on volunteers to extend our reach and impact. From providing homework and employment assistance, to offering companionship and social connections, their compassion and commitment have enriched countless lives.

We extend our heartfelt gratitude to every one of our 189 volunteers who have selflessly given their time and talents to support our community.

Congratulations to our Armidale Homework Centre volunteer team who have received richly deserved recognition, winning best volunteer team firstly for Armidale, and then at the regional level in the New England Regional Volunteering Awards.

As we look to the future, we are excited to announce Mosaic is moving its head office to new premises in Charlestown. While we cherish the history and connection our community has with the building we have occupied in Hamilton for nearly four decades, we recognise the need for a space that better reflects our growing organisation and the evolving needs of our clients.

Our new facility will provide us with the resources and flexibility to expand our programs, enhance our services, and create a more inclusive and accessible environment for all. We are eager to embark on this exciting new chapter and continue to serve our community with the same passion and dedication that has defined Mosaic for over 40 years.

We are deeply grateful to our community, volunteers, board and staff for their unwavering support. Your dedication and hard work have been instrumental in making Mosaic a thriving organisation.

Let's continue to collaborate with heart, passion and goodwill, and celebrate the diversity and resilience of our community. Together we are committed to achieving our mission to support culturally diverse individuals and communities to overcome barriers and thrive.

Sharon Daishe

Chief Executive Officer



PROGRAM REPORTS

This year at Mosaic Multicultural Connections, we continued to build on our mission of empowering diverse communities by fostering inclusion, promoting equity, and driving meaningful change.



Our programs have reached new milestones, creating tangible impacts in the lives of individuals and families across various age groups and cultural backgrounds. Together, we've cultivated resilience, opportunity, and hope.



Mosaic Aged Care Annual Report

Overview

Mosaic's Aged Care Team provides programs, services and support to Australians over the age of 65 years (or over 55 if you identify as Aboriginal or Torres Strait Islander), with a focus on clients from a culturally and linguistically diverse background.

This year has seen meaningful change within Mosaic's aged care services. In September 2023 the service was restructured resulting in many long standing staff choosing to farewell Mosaic. New care partner and service coordinators were hired to serve as key contacts for our Home Care Package (HCP) clients and our commonwealth Home Support Package (CHSP) clients respectively.

Hot on the heels of the restructure, Mosaic was audited by the Aged Care Quality and Safety Commission in January 2024. This audit highlighted some significant areas of improvement for Mosaic to address. The report was received at the same time as the General Manager and Manager Aged Care roles turned over. Our new management team jumped immediately to implementing a quality improvement plan.

+ **Care**
Partner

+ **Service**
Coordinators

+ **Team**
Restructure

+ **Quality**
Improvement Plan

The quality improvement included:

- Review and update of all client care plans to ensure that every client has their needs clearly documented
- Improved rostering processes to ensure that we have the right staff with the right client at the right time
- Regular recruitment of care staff, with majority being permanent rather than casual, making service consistent for clients and staff
- Improved clinical care through recruitment and onboarding of a Registered Nurse
- Refresh of the clinical governance committee ensuring that our service is actively reviewed by a subcommittee of Mosaic board
- Introduction of our consumer advisory body giving voice to our clients direct to the management and the clinical governance committee
- Improved financial visibility, processes and reporting introduced



GALLERY





Mosaic Aged Care Annual Report

Overview

Each of these improvements ensures that Mosaic is fully compliant with the Aged Care Standards.

We were very pleased to have a follow up visit and audit review with the Commission in September 2024. This review confirmed that we had made progress, and Mosaic is now fully compliant with the Standards.

At, 30 June 2024 we were providing care and support to 83 home care clients, had delivered over 4,800 hours of respite care to more than 75 clients, and 3,957 hours of social support to 100 clients.

Overall, our team provides care, support and assistance through case management, service delivery, clinical and nursing services, and education to older people who are our clients.

We aim to keep individuals connected to their communities. We assist them to participate in activities that are important to them and promote and facilitate their independence, and offering support where and when needed.

↑ **83**

Home Care Clients

↑ **4800+**

hours Respite Care

↑ **100+**

Social Support
Care Clients

↑ **3957+**

Hours Social
Support

Mosaic Aged Care Services works through the following programs

- Home Care Packages (HCP)
- Flexible Respite under the Commonwealth Home Support Program (CHSP).
- Individual Social support under the Commonwealth Home Support Program (CHSP).
- The Aged Care Volunteer Visitors Scheme (formerly Community Visitors Scheme).



Mosaic Aged Care Annual Report

Our Home Care Program

Home Care Packages provide personal services in the comfort of your own home. As at 30 June 2024 we were providing care and support to 83 home care clients. We can assist you to stay living in your home to continue doing all the things you want to do. With the right services and support we can assist you to remain as independent as possible.

We can assist you with care and support services such as personal care, showering and grooming, continence management, cleaning and household tasks, grocery shopping, washing and ironing, social support, transport to appointments and social events and in-home respite.

Through our nursing care and specialised support services we can arrange for a Registered Nurse to visit you in your home to provide clinical care to assist you to monitor your blood pressure, manage your diabetes, manage your medication and to dress and care for any wounds.

We can also arrange visits by accredited occupational therapists, physiotherapists, exercise physiologists, and podiatrists. As the new Aged Care standards are introduced our staff are preparing to increase our service provision even further.

Eligibility

You may be eligible for support from our Aged Care team if you:

- are over 65 and need coordinated services to help you to stay in your home (or over 55 if you identify as Aboriginal or Torres Strait Islander)
- need assistance to complete everyday tasks
- from a culturally and linguistically diverse background
- register with My Aged Care first (www.myagedcare.gov.au)

For more information and to understand if you are eligible for our aged care services, please call our aged care coordinators on 1800 813 205 or email myagedcare@mosaicmc.org.au

Individual Social Support

Our dedicated staff or volunteers can assist you to remain socially connected to your community by accompanying you to activities such as taking you to pay your bills, attending appointments, attending social events and activities with family and friends, assisting you with telephone and technologies to stay connected with your community and by visiting you at home for social connections, conversations and catch ups. We offer language-specific services to enhance cultural connections.

Flexible Respite

Our flexible respite program allows you to receive care in your own home to allow your carer to take a break from their caring role knowing that the person that they care for is being well looked after by a trusted member of our care team.

Community Visitors Scheme

For those clients who are receiving a home care package or a resident in an aged care facility, the program matches volunteers to the client so that they can spend some quality social time together and develop companionship, friendships, and interests.





Mosaic Multicultural Families Annual Report

Our Program

Mosaic's Multicultural Families team provides specialist support for families with children up to 18 years. The team offers programs, support and activities to help parents and families from culturally and linguistically diverse backgrounds (CALD) raise happy and healthy families. This year we have supported over 160 clients.

Our experienced team visits new parents in their home to support them and ensure they are connected to health and other government services and community agencies. Our team help to link families to other specialised service providers to address their specific needs.

The Multicultural Families program is funded by the NSW Department of Communities and Justice (DCJ) through the Targeted Earlier Intervention program.



Women's Support Groups

Our women's support groups are a great way for women to meet up, share with others and discover more about parenting in a supportive environment. Each month over 10 women meet for support and education on parenting. They are also a great way to build a parent's social network.



Great Parents Raising Great Kids

Our experienced team deliver evidence-based programs such as Bringing Up Great Kids so that mums and dads can learn more about raising great kids, and Circle of Security which helps parents understand how to respond to their children's emotional needs. These programs are provided in a culturally safe manner in small groups ensuring that parents can learn and grow together.



Mosaic Settlement and Communities Annual Report

Our Program

The Settlement and Communities team delivered 17 programs from 15 funding sources for people from migrant and refugee backgrounds.

Our team of over 27 permanent and casual staff have worked tirelessly throughout the year providing information, advice and referral, advocacy, casework, community education, group work, volunteer support, youth activities and more.

Settlement Support

The Settlement Engagement and Transition Support (SETS) program is funded by the Department of Home Affairs. This financial year was the final year of the NSW Settlement Partnership (NSP) led by Settlement Services International (SSI), of which Mosaic was a founding member. Mosaic received funding via SSI to provide settlement support for newly arrived migrants and refugees in Newcastle and the Hunter, Lake Macquarie and Central Coast, Tamworth and Armidale. It was a privilege to be part of the consortium over the years, and we thank SSI for their stewardship.

Our Settlement Services support people to build their knowledge and ability to find, access and use other community services and become independent. Through 2023-2024 our Settlement and Communities team were able to deliver assistance and support to 908 clients providing 5,152 individual sessions of service.

The people we support came from more than 60 different countries of birth, with the top five countries being Iraq, Syria, Afghanistan, Democratic Republic of Congo, and The Republic of the Union of Myanmar.

Healthy relationships

This year we have provided sensitive and responsive support to many people who have or are experiencing domestic and family violence (DFV). We distributed information brochures to more than 250 people.

This year we received additional funding from Dept Communities and Justice to provide domestic and family violence information sessions in Armidale for the community. We call this the BEAM project. Through this project we provided 11 sessions for 27 women (15-20 women meeting each month) raising awareness within the community of domestic and family violence and the supports available.

Cultural connections

More than 10 women joined Mosaic's monthly Arabic women's group; more than 20 women joined the Afghan Women's group. More than 15 women joined the women's group in Armidale (mostly from the Ezidi community) held each fortnight. And over 10 men and women joined a weekly group held on the Central Coast.

These groups provide a stable safe space where key information about healthy relationships, growth, information and peer support and resources are distributed. These groups also provide social connection for vulnerable women.

We also work with men through community education, and support behaviour change in those who have used violence in their family relationships.

Highlights



5152

Individual
Sessions



60+

Countries of
Birth



17

Programs



908

Clients



GALLERY



EDUCATION



SUPPORT

ENGAGEMENT



AWARENESS



Mosaic Multicultural Settlement and Communities Annual Report

Cultural Connection

Mosaic is proud of our strong connection to the communities that we serve. To ensure that our services remain relevant and meet the ever-changing needs of the community we are committed to continuing to meet regularly with various community groups. Our community meetings provide opportunity for two way information sharing.

This year:

- We ran 8 community consultation sessions with Pasifika Island communities and introduced them to the Pacific Engagement Visa (PEV) scheme.
- We conducted 2 multicultural community consultations to identify the gaps and challenges CALD communities are facing.
- We supported the 2 events of Ramadan, Iftar dinners at Mayfield mosques and Wallsend mosques.
- We are the crucial partner of Religious and Community Leaders round table seminars organised by NSW Department of Communities and Justice (DCJ).
- We organised and ran the CCMI multicultural expo on the central coast.

Community Connection

Working with children and families from culturally and linguistically diverse communities continues to be a joy on the Central Coast. Our regular group Playing Around the World and Talking Around the World playgroups continued to grow in Wyong, Blue Haven, The Entrance and Mardi.

It has been exciting to see the "New Mums" Group provide a valuable and safe place for new mums to share their own rich cultural parenting practices with others.

The group helps to break down social isolation especially for those who have limited family and friends around them in Australia.

Approximately 215 women and children attended sessions in the past year.

Highlights

↑ **10**
Community
Sessions

↑ **2**
Iftar Dinners

↑ **215**
Women and
children

+ **Crucial**
Partner





Mosaic Multicultural Settlement and Communities Annual Report

REAP Armidale



The Regional Employment Agricultural Project (REAP) in Armidale originally commenced in partnership with The Rotary Club of Armidale, with Mosaic then securing funding from the Department of Employment and Workplace Relations under the Local Jobs Program National Priority Fund.

Mosaic's collaboration with the Rotary Club of Armidale and the Ezidi community commenced as a project focused on growing produce on local farming land and enabling the growers to sell surplus produce at local markets.



Late in the financial year the partnership with Rotary ended. We want to thank the Rotary Club of Armidale for their commitment to the community project, and the many hours they volunteered with the growers. REAP is pivoted to focus on preparing the community for future employment opportunities in upcoming local renewable energy projects and other industries.

At the end of June 2024, we have over 110 active participants. This year participants have completed White Card and First Aid Certificate courses, taken advantage of work experience with a freight company, and learned about work place rights.





Mosaic Multicultural Settlement and Communities Annual Report



In Armidale, our team have shown our commitment to diversity and inclusion by establishing the Multicultural Youth Advisory Committee in collaboration with local agencies and government funding bodies.

The advisory committee, led by Mosaic, was instrumental in arranging a successful youth forum, a collaborative effort with DCJ and Armidale Secondary College. This forum was attended by over 100 young people and demonstrated the power of working together.

Youth Work

Mosaic's Northern Multicultural Youth Exchange program works to build engagement, relationships, mutual understanding and respect with young people from regional communities including Aboriginal and Torres Strait Islanders.

+ 100+
Youth Collaborations

+ 200+
Youth Engagements



Weekly youth group events continued to be popular for youth, providing space to explore culture, understanding and belonging. Youth exchange events included visits to parliament house, visits to Sydney, and multiple sporting events and competitions – especially volley ball and soccer.





Mosaic Multicultural Settlement and Communities Annual Report

Homework Centres

Mosaic continues to run our impactful Homework and Learning Centres in partnership with Jesmond Primary School, Heaton Primary School, and Waratah Technology Campus in Newcastle, and Drummond Primary School in Armidale. This year our homework centres provided support to 76 children, only made possible by the support of 65 volunteers. Every term, our homework tutors provide a student progress report including comments from the students.

Our Mosaic volunteers have assisted student groups from Syrian, Kurdish, Iraqi, Afghan, Congolese and Ezidi refugee backgrounds. At the New England Regional Volunteering Awards, the Armidale EALD Homework Centre not only won the best Volunteering Team for Armidale but also at the regional level. It is great to be recognised with 14 years of support from volunteers.

“

Homework Centre is my favourite time of the week. I like learning new things with the volunteers, especially maths. The fire brigade was the best – I have 15 people living in my house and making a fire safety plan to get us all out to the letterbox is pretty important.

”

8 year old girl from Samoa

“

I like Homework Centre because the volunteers are great – they are kind and never get cross. I especially like the art and drama with Mr D on a Wednesday. I would recommend Homework Centre to new children to Armidale.

”

11 year old girl from Bhutan

“

Some of the Homework Centre activities are really fun. I like playing soccer at the end with my friends. Homework Centre has been helpful for my English, and I have learned lots about the Australian culture – it is so different from my own culture

”

11 year old boy from Egypt

“

I am new to English. I like reading and maths. I like the games in the cupboard for when I am getting tired.

”

11 year old boy from Iraq

Highlights



76+

Children
Supported



65+

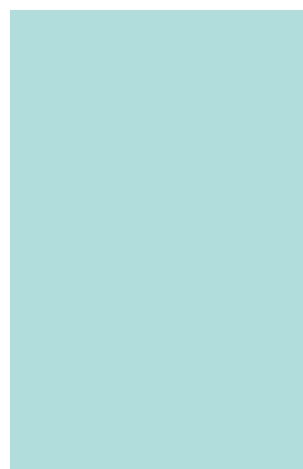
Volunteer
Tutors



Best

Regional
Volunteering Team





GALLERY



Mosaic Multicultural Settlement and Communities Annual Report

Gamble Aware

The GambleAware campaign is designed as a thought starter to encourage people to think about how gambling might be impacting their lives and for those who might be at risk of gambling harm to check out the full range of information, support and treatment options available through GambleAware.

It features relatable scenarios showing how gambling can impact our everyday lives in ways we might not realise and potentially jeopardise relationships, jobs and even our kids. The light-hearted approach is designed to make it more comfortable to think about and talk about gambling.

This year we commence providing supports for people struggling with gambling. The service provides Information and education for multicultural communities regarding gambling choices and impacts.

NSW Governments latest campaign asks you to consider if gambling is impacting your life. Supporting this initiative, several training sessions were provided for staff and for people in our multicultural communities about the impacts of gambling and how to seek assistance.

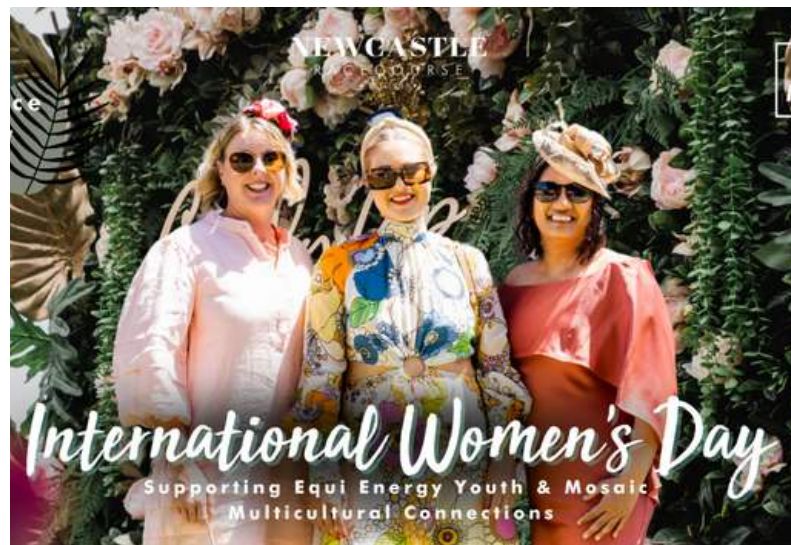
This service is funded by the NSW Office of Responsible Gambling.



International Women's Day Fundraising Event

Mosaic was privileged to be nominated by Ali Kimmorley of People Fusion as one of two charities to benefit from the International Women's Day (IWD) fundraiser event at Newcastle Racecourse on Friday 1st March 2024. Mosaic settlement worker, Alyaa Al Attabi, and Samira Ahmadi from Newcastle Hazara Community, spoke to the audience of over 350 about the challenges and isolation they experienced when they arrived in Australia with no support network to help them settle in their new home.

With this lived experience, Alyaa is passionate about her work in Mosaic's settlement programs including providing support through Mosaic's Arabic Speaking Women's Group.



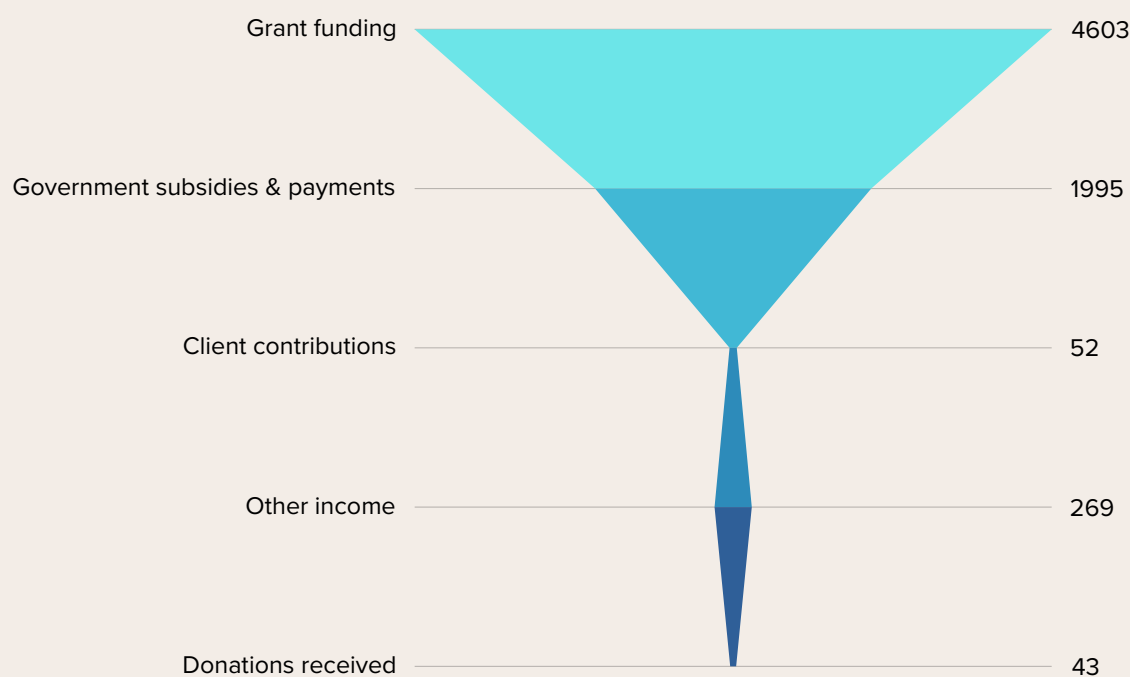
It was with gratitude that we received a generous donation of \$25,000 from the IWD event. These funds have been used to organise women-only community programs. At the end of 2023, we took more than 90 women to the Hunter Valley Gardens for a memorable activity.



Mosaic Financial Annual Report

Revenue (\$'000)

Total: \$6,961k



Expenditure (\$'000)

Total: \$7,055k



Acknowledging Our Staff

Mosaic warmly acknowledges every staff member who has been part of our team throughout 2023-2024. Thank you for your contribution to Mosaic and our clients over this year.





Celebrating Our Volunteers

Mosaic is deeply grateful to more than 175 volunteers who contribute their time and talent so generously every year. We acknowledge these wonderful people and express our deepest appreciation for their participation and contribution to Mosaic and our clients over this year.



Recognising Our Diversity

Mosaic staff can speak, read or write 42 languages





“A COMMUNITY WHERE DIVERSITY DEFINES AND NOURISHES US”

We envision a future where diversity weaves a strong, unified fabric that binds our community. Trust is the foundation of this vision—where every individual flourishes through openness and mutual respect. Just like the Ocean connects all values, diversity becomes the driving force that nourishes growth.

OUR VISION

OUR MISSION

“SUPPORTING DIVERSE COMMUNITIES”

We empower culturally diverse individuals to overcome barriers by creating spaces where trust, transparency, and collaboration fuel growth.

Our mission is to uplift and inspire, providing pathways for every person to thrive in a world that embraces their uniqueness.





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